

WEEK REPORT 9

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Mohamed Akmal Jahangeer
Apr 28, 2026 1:05 PM ⋮

I am thoroughly impressed by KDE Plasma. If GNOME is about staying out of your way with a "less is more" philosophy, Plasma is about giving you the power to make the desktop exactly what you want it to be.

Coming from a Windows background, the initial layout felt very familiar, but the depth of customization is on another level. I loved the "Widgets" system, which allows you to pin system monitors or sticky notes directly to the desktop. I explored this using KDE neon, which is a fantastic distribution because it provides the absolute latest features from the KDE team on top of a stable Ubuntu base. It felt incredibly snappy and surprisingly "light" on system resources, despite having all the flashy animations and transparency effects enabled. For anyone who loves to tweak every single detail—from the window decorations to the way the mouse behaves—KDE Plasma is easily the best choice.

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Kevin Gerlein
he/him
Apr 27, 2026 12:34 AM (Edited by Kevin Gerlein on Apr 27, 2026 12:35 AM)

Personally, I find that using Linux Mint with the Xfce desktop environment is very interesting. I chose this particular distro due to its similarity to the Windows desktop environment and it works immediately without any heavy setup. I liked using Xfce with Linux Mint because it's very light weight and very fast, which would be a plus for virtual machines or older systems. On a personal level, while using Linux Mint (using DistroSea), I really enjoyed that it felt almost nostalgic to the classic Windows layout, which I am quite accustomed to. I also enjoyed the fact that Linux Mint (Xfce) had very sleek menu designs, and it felt like an inspiration to Windows, but not completely a Windows knock off.

-Desktop Environment: Xfce
- Linux distro: Linux Mint (v22.3)
Xfce website: <https://www.xfce.org/>
Linux Mint website: <https://linuxmint.com/>

LAB9 NOTES